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Title of the article: *Meritorious Heroes: Allegorical Hawk Paintings in Yuan China and Early Chos n Korea*

The content extracted is as follows:

The Allegory Developed and Established in Yuan China

The allegory of a heroic hawk is most evident in three poems by Yuan scholars that appear in a collection of poems inscribed on paintings.¹⁰ These three poems are Shanyingtu (Painting of Two Hawks) by Gong Shitai (1298-1362), Ti huaying (Inscribed on a Hawk Painting) by Li Qi (active mid-fourteenth century), and Ti Liu Luchu Suozhang Mo Qingshan Ying (Inscribed on a Hawk Painted by Mo Qingshan at the Home of Liu Luchu) by Guo Yu (1316-?).

In these poems, rabbits and foxes take on the role of thieves, and the mighty hawks righteously inflict justice on them.

He Ning (898-955), another Tang poet, had also written about a hawk and a rabbit in a poem titled Ti yin jietutu (Inscribed on a Painting of a Hawk Hunting a Rabbit): You may boast of the swiftness of the hawk's eyes, but I feel sorry for the rabbit's frightened heart (, ; Yuding lidai tihuashilei , 94:9b).

The phrase even came to describe quick and powerful brushstrokes in calligraphy and painting.¹¹ Unlike their precedents, the three Yuan poems describe the hawks as contemplative yet vigilant, perched motionless on trees and staring out into the sky, neither scanning for prey nor hunting.

The poems instead focus on the hawk's posture and explain why the hawks in the paintings do not need to hunt because they have already subdued the rabbits and foxes.

Overall, the three Yuan poems manifest the following allegory: a military general or inspector general (the hawk) has subjugated all the cunning crowds of corrupt officials (the rabbits and foxes) and brought peace to the world (the forest) that is governed by a wise ruler (the falconer), but the general is ready to use force when needed. The allegory was flexible in terms of exhibiting one's political standing.

4) is an excellent example of the hawk-hero allegory.¹⁶ Although the painter is unknown, the scroll has five poem inscriptions that reveal its functional meaning.

The inscribers from the late Yuan and early Ming are Mo Shian , Zou Yi , Pan Ruoshui , Yang Quan , and Cai You .¹⁷ They all extol the hawk's accomplishments as follows: Although the painting does not depict rabbits or foxes, all the inscribed poems mention these sly creatures.

Some of the inscribers worked for the Yuan and also held government posts in the early Ming.²⁰ Moreover, a line from one of the poems indicates the difficulty of founding a country.²¹ The painting in question shows the hawk agitated, fluffing up its chest, with sharply turned head looking out with piercing eyes.

Yingxiong, which literally means hawk and bear, is a homonym in Mandarin with yingxiong , which means hero.²² Zhou Tingzhen (b. 1294), who tried unsuccessfully to become an official under the Mongol government, composed a poem about a painting titled Painting of a Hawk and a Bear Listening to a Stream (Yingxiong tingjian tu).

Upon seeing it, he wrote a poem titled On the Painting of a Hawk and Bear on the Wall of Tongyang Inn, I Sing of It with the Rhyme of a Poem by Chen Jiaoyu. According to Ch ng, Chen Jiaoyu (Chen De , 1330-78) composed the poem at the order of Jiang Yinhou (1324-81), who fought for the establishment of the Ming dynasty.

Chen's poem, already written before Ch ng's visit, touched Ch ng and prompted him to write a long poem: The painting Ch ng saw must have displayed excellent execution.

It certainly led Ch ng to consider his own loyalty, as he wrote: I hope to bow to the emperor after I fulfill some meritorious deed. Although the Chinese emperor in 1386 was the first emperor of the Ming dynasty, the painting on the wall and the poems gracing it show the long usage of yingxiong painting since the Yuan.

Ch ng's poem is valuable evidence that attests to the existence of a hawk-and-bear

painting with the message of bravery and loyalty and also its dissemination, as it was displayed in a location where numerous people came and went during the late Yuan and early Ming periods.

Although the painting at the Tongyang Inn with Chen's poem inscribed on it is no longer extant, we can presume that such an impressive hawk-and-bear painting alluding to loyalty was not a one-off in China.

The Allegory Received and Transformed in Early Chosŏn Korea

Several scholars from the late Koryŏ and early Chosŏn periods praised his poem on the hawk-and-bear painting.

Chŏng's poem inscribed on the hawk-and-bear painting also became symbolic of his allegiance to Koryŏ.

However, Korean scholars who read Chŏng's poem were not able to see the painting mentioned in the poem and catch the homophonic pun, so they were not particularly interested in the combination of the hawk and bear.

Despite the interest Chŏng's poem generated among scholars, therefore, Yingxiong paintings did not catch on in Korea.

Among early Chosŏn scholars' poems on hawk paintings, we find only one written about a Korean painter's work.

The poem describes An's painting as portraying a hawk on its perch.

A poem on An Kyŏn's hawk painting identified the bird as a hero with a chivalrous disposition.

Another poem, *Hwa'ng* (On the Painting of a Hawk) by the influential scholar-official Sŏk-jŏng (1420–88),² describes the hawk as a hero: According to Sŏ's poem, a skillful painter has depicted a white hawk sitting motionless and with dignified features, such as white feathers, green talons, and yellow pupils.

The hawk is not currently hunting but remains faithful to its owner, who may need its hunting ability; it awaits the day when his service would be required. The hawk is like a perfectly prepared general, waiting to render merit for the sake of the country and, of course, for the king.²⁸ This poem has a different nuance from the Yuan dynasty poems discussed above.

In the following century, the renowned scholar Kim Inhu (1510–60) used the same allegory in his poem on a hawk painting, which expresses his anticipation of playing the role of a truly loyal subject with outstanding ability: The painting Kim saw must have been a simple image of a hawk perched rather than in the act of hunting.

The poem *A Hawk Seizes a Rabbit in Autumn, the King's New Year's Painting for Me* (Susasehwa sohwa Ch'ungbakt'o) reveals his thoughts on the meaning of the hawk in the painting: The scene of the rabbit attacked by the hawk must have been surprisingly vivid, because the only comment Sŏng Hyŏn makes directly on the painting is the phrase surprised by this painting of a rabbit struck. What surprises him is the hawk's power and swift, resolute behavior.

At the time of composing this poem, Sŏng had recently been appointed by the king as hyŏngjo ch'amp'an, a position akin to vice minister, in the Ministry of Justice.²⁹ When Sŏng swears his allegiance to the king and the obligations of his high position, he uses the allegory of the hawk fulfilling its role in the future.

Yi's paintings were highly appreciated in Chosŏn Korea, where many scholars wrote poems on his works.³¹ Yi also gained a great reputation for his hawk paintings.

Sin Kwanghan (1484–1555), a scholar-official who composed many poems on Yi's paintings, described a pair of scrolls titled *White Hawk and Black Hawk* (Sin Kwanghan 1573, 3:11b–12a).

According to Sin's poem, Yi's two hawks evinced a heroic spirit, gracefully and peacefully perched. At least three paintings with Yi's seal that depict a perched hawk remain today, although whether these paintings inspired Sin's poem remains unclear.³² Yi Am further developed the image of a hawk hunting a rabbit, which was rare in the history of Chinese hawk painting but became widespread in Chosŏn Korea.

Na Sik's poem portrays the scene of the capture as follows: The poem describes the scene of a rabbit under the sharp talons of a hawk.

It shows a fierce hawk clutching a rabbit and wild birds crying in the trees, echoing

the scene described in Na Sik's poem.

After the Allegory of Meritorious Hero

The Ming scholar Cheng Minzheng's (1445-99) poem on the painting titled *Heroes Fighting for a Pheasant* (Yingxiong duojin) makes the meaning clear (Cheng 1773-85, 88:21b): to hold a pheasant is to win an honorable prize.³⁵ Cheng's poem conveys that the image of a hawk holding a pheasant is a figurative expression for a promising scholar who has passed the civil examination.

According to a poem by He Jingming (1483-1521), in one such painting by the well-known court painter Lin Liang (1436-87), the white-headed bird signified a baidu bird, which in turn indicated human old age.

The baidu of baidu bird is , or white head a metaphor for longevity that appeared continuously throughout the history of Chinese painting.³⁶ The poem by He Jingming (Dafuji 13:25b) tells of the message of the painting: Lin Liang's drawing skill is truly outstanding.

The Chosŏn scholar Yi Kiji (1690-1722) mentions the painting in a poem: People laugh too hard at the pheasant under the rock.